

Alabama Learning Hour

Ava is hiding! Introducing *-ka* Verbs

April 7th, 2026

1 *Avak ittillonkan hompanihchi!* Text

Avak aatilloinka hompanihchi
Avak aatwihlimon, Jacob, Tanya, Maxinekan holonkahchi.
Tanyak, “Jacob, nakson loĩskā?”
Jacobkak, “itto oobali lonkalo”
Jacobkak, “Nakson loĩskā hasna?”
Tanyan Maxinkaya, “isa obaali lonko”
Tanyan Maxinekak, isa oobali amaako. Jacobka itto obaalin hachaalilo.
Avak aatwihlo imokla. Itto obaali Jacobka hiicho.
Avak, “Jacob, chichaalo!”
Tanyan Maxinekaya hoafaakati. Avak “naksok afaakā?”
Tanyan Maxinekak, “kosnok afaailko!”. Isa oobali maachoffo.
Avak, “oyhan hachihichalo!”

Ava is playing hide and seek!

Ava is playing hide and seek.

Ava is seeking, and Jacob, Tanya, and Maxine are hiding.

Tanya says, "Jacob, where are you hiding?"

Jacob says "I am hiding behind the tree."

Jacob says "Tanya and Maxine, where are ya'll hiding?"

Tanya and Maxine says "we are hiding behind the house."

Tanya and Maxine go behind the house. Jacob stands behind the tree.

Ava starts to look for her friends. She looks behind the tree, and finds Jacob.

Ava says "Jacob, I found you!"

Tanya and Maxine laugh. Ava says "Who is laughing?"

Tanya and Maxine say "we are laughing!". They jump behind the house.

Ava says "I found you all!"

2 Vocabulary

Nouns

nakson	where
itto	tree
isa	house
imokla	friends

Verbs

aatwihli	to find
lonka	to hide
hiicha	to see
amaaka	to go
hachaali	to stand
maachoffi	to jump out
afaaka	to laugh

Other

oobali behind
hasna ya'll

3 -ka Verbs

- In the previous lessons, we have talking about what *someone else* (usually Ava) has been doing.
- Today, we will learn how to talk about myself, ourselves, yourself, and yourselves!
- Today's focus will be on this topic, because the way the verb changes in Alabama is quite different to English.
- For example, in English, the verb looks quite similar when we're talking about myself/yourself/ourselves/yourselves:

- (1)
- | | |
|---------------------|-----------------------------|
| a. <i>I swim</i> | d. <i>We swim</i> |
| b. <i>You swim</i> | e. <i>Ya'll swim</i> |
| c. <i>Ava swims</i> | f. <i>The children swim</i> |

- In Alabama, the verb has one form if you're talking about *myself*, another if you're talking about *yourself*, and so on.
- Additionally, this form is different across different "types" of verbs!
- Today, we will focus on just one type of verb: verbs that end in *-ka*.

Example -ka verbs

- | | |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| • afaaka 'to laugh' | • hakchoobiika 'to kneel' |
| • loska 'to lie' | • hifoska 'to breathe' |
| • naaŋiika "to speak" | • isko "to drink" |
| • innaaŋiika "to read" | • lonka "to hide" |

Watch Out! *isko* doesn't end in *-ka*, but it behaves exactly the same as verbs that do end in *ka*. And, *ko* does sound very similar to *ka*.

Let's practice! *Let's practice our new vocab with Kahoot!*

<https://create.kahoot.it/share/vocab-ava-plays-hide-and-peek/3185097c-54df-4b43-b816-48a8364d2f1c>

- We can start using these verbs in a sentence.
- We will first learn how to talk about myself (*I*), someone else (*he/she/it*), and multiple other people (*they*).
- To talk about *me* (*I lied*), you add the *-li* at the end of the verb.

– **loska** → **loska-li-ti** “I lied”

- To talk about *someone else*, like *Ava*, or *Diego*, just use the dictionary form.

– **loska** → **Avak loska-ti** “Ava lied”

- If you want to talk about many other people, like *the children*, just use the dictionary form, and add *ho* to the start if you want.

– **loska** → **poskohak ho-loska-ti** “The children lied”

Let's practice! *How would you say this in Alabama?*

afaaka ‘to laugh’

- (2)
- a. I laughed.
 - b. Ava laughed.
 - c. The children (*poskoha*) laughed.

hifoska ‘to breathe’

- (4)
- a. I breathed.
 - b. Ava breathed.
 - c. The children (*poskoha*) breathed.

hakchoobiika ‘to kneel’

- (3)
- a. I kneeled.
 - b. Ava kneeled.
 - c. The children (*poskoha*) kneeled.

isko ‘to drink’

- (5)
- a. I drank.
 - b. Ava drank.
 - c. The children (*poskoha*) drank.

- Using *you*, *ya'll* and *we* with *ka* verbs are a bit different.
- To use *ka* verbs with *you*, put the piece **is** before *ka*.
 - **loska** → **los-is-ka-ti** “You lied”
- To use *ka* verbs with *ya'll*, put the piece **has** before *ka*.
 - **loska** → **los-has-ka-ti** → **los-as-ka-ti** “Ya'll lied”
- You may have noticed that the *h* sound is missing from *has* in *lonaskati*. Sometimes, when *s* and *h* come together, the *h* drops. It's just easier to say that way!
- To use *ka* verbs with *we*, put the piece **il** before *ka*.
 - **loska** → **los-il-ka-ti** “We lied”
- Before we go onto practice these, there are a couple of pronunciation points I wanted to mention.
- The first is *-ka* verbs that have an *n* before the *-ka*, like *lonka* “to hide”.
 - These verbs are pronounced slightly differently for *you*, *ya'll*, and *we*. The *n* disappears and we pronounce the *o* with a snotty nose: **lōiskati** “you hid”
- The second is about verbs that end in *ko*, like *isko* “to drink”:
 - Even though *isko* ends in *ko*, and *ka*, *isko* is still a *ka* verb.
 - When talking about *you*, *ya'll*, and *we*, the *ko* becomes *ka*
 - **isko** → **is-il-ka-ti** “we drank”
- These rules are summarized in the following box. This is our recipe to use any *ka* agent verb!

Agent Verb Sentence Recipe - Verbs that end in -ka

[Verb + Agent + ka + Tense]

- Except for *I/me*, which has the recipe:

[Verb + ka + Agent + Tense]

Agent Morphemes:

	Singular	Plural	
1	-li 'I'	-il- 'we'	1st person = speaker
2	-is- 'you'	-has- 'y'all'	2nd person = person you're talking to
3		(ho)- 'They'	3rd person = someone else

- (6)
- loska** + **li** + **ti** = *loskaliti* 'I lied'
 - los** + **is** + **ka** + **ti** = *losiskati* 'You lied'
 - loska** + **ti** = *loskati* 'He/She lied'
 - los** + **il** + **ka** + **ti** = *losilkati* 'we lied'
 - los** + **has** + **ka** + **ti** = *losaskati* 'Y'all lied'
 - (ho)** + **loska** + **ti** = *(ho)loskati* 'They lied'

Let's practice! *How would you say this in Alabama?*

afaaka 'to laugh'

- (7) a. I laughed.
 b. You laughed.
 c. Ava laughed.
 d. We laughed.
 e. Y'all laughed.
 f. The children (*poskoha*)
 laughed.

hakchoobiika 'to kneel'

- (8) a. I kneeled.
 b. You kneeled.
 c. Ava kneeled.
 d. We kneeled.
 e. Y'all kneeled.
 f. The children (*poskoha*)
 kneeled.

hifoska 'to breathe'

- (9) a. I will breathed.
 b. You breathed.
 c. Ava breathed.
 d. We breathed.
 e. Y'all breathed.
 f. The children (*poskoha*)
 breathed.

naaŋiika 'to speak'

- (11) a. I spoke.
 b. You spoke.
 c. Ava spoke.
 d. We spoke.
 e. Y'all spoke.
 f. The children (*poskoha*)
 spoke.

isko 'to drink'

- (10) a. I drank.
 b. You drank.
 c. Ava drank.
 d. We drank.
 e. Y'all drank.
 f. The children (*poskoha*)
 drank.

innnaaŋiika 'to read'

- (12) a. I read (past tense).
 b. You read.
 c. Ava read.
 d. We read.
 e. Y'all read.
 f. The children (*poskoha*)
 read.

4 Asking Where Questions

- Let's finish up this lesson playing a game of hide and seek!
- Last week, we learnt how to ask *where* someone is doing something.

Asking 'where questions' Easy Recipe

[Naksi + -fon + Agent + Verb]

- (13) a. **naksi** + **-fon** + **Avak** + **bitlihchi**
where Ava is.dancing
'Where is Ava dancing?'

Answering 'where questions' Easy Recipe

[Agent-k + Place + -fon + Verb]

- (14) a. **Avak** + **ischoopasi** + **-fon** + **bitlihchi**
Ava store at/to/from is.dancing =
Avak ischoopasifon bitlihchi.
'Ava is dancing at the store.'

- For example, we can say:
Q:Naksifon Avak bitlihchi?
A: Avak ischoopasifon bitlihchi

Let's Practice! *Recall our location words from last week. Let's review this vocab together with the -ka verbs we've been learning today!*

Example Location words

- | | | |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| • iisa 'home/house' | • okichoba 'lake' | • bokkochaaha
'mountain' |
| • ayahchihka 'gar-
den' | • ischoopasi
'store' | • Dalaska 'Dallas' |
| • abohli 'forest' | • isoba 'church' | • Yosti/Houstonka
'Houston' |

<https://create.kahoot.it/share/more-vocab-ava-plays-hide-and-seek/6b4b96d4-112d-4ed7-a769-b7c1b4e10f5c>

Let's Practice! *With a partner, play hide and seek! Use the verb lonka, which means "to hide", and ask your partner where someone is hiding. Remember, lonka is a ka verb.*

Example Location words

- **iisa** 'home/house'
- **okichoba** 'lake'
- **bokkochaaha** 'mountain'
- **ayahchihka** 'garden'
- **ischoopasi** 'store'
- **Dalaska** 'Dallas'
- **abohli** 'forest'
- **isoba** 'church'
- **Yosti/Houstonka** 'Houston'

Agent Verb Sentence Recipe - Verbs that end in -ka

[**Verb** + **Agent** + **ka** + **Tense**]

- Except for *I/me*, which has the recipe:

[**Verb** + **ka** + **Agent** + **Tense**]

Agent Morphemes:

	Singular	Plural	
1	-li 'I'	-il- 'we'	<i>1st person = speaker</i>
2	-is- 'you'	-has- 'y'all'	<i>2nd person = person you're talking to</i>
3	verb (e.g. <i>loska</i>)	(ho)- 'They'	<i>3rd person = someone else</i>

- (15) a. Where is Ava hiding?
b. Ava is hiding _____.

(17) a. Where are ya'll hiding?
b. We are hiding _____.

(16) a. Where are you hiding?
b. I am hiding _____.

(18) a. Where are the children hiding?
b. The children are hiding _____.

Let's Practice! *With a partner, ask where someone is doing the action.*

Example Location words

- **iisa** ‘home/house’
- **ayahchihka** ‘garden’
- **abohli** ‘forest’
- **okichoba** ‘lake’
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Agent Morphemes:

	Singular	Plural	
1	-li ‘I’	-il- ‘we’	<i>1st person = speaker</i>
2	-is- ‘you’	-has- ‘y’ all’	<i>2nd person = person you’re talking to</i>
3	verb (e.g. <i>loska</i>)	(ho)- ‘They’	<i>3rd person = someone else</i>

- (19) a. Where is Ava laughing? (21) a. Where are ya'll
(*afaaka*) speaking? (*naaʔiika*)
b. Ava is laughing _____. b. We are speaking
_____.
- (20) a. Where are you reading? (22) a. Where are the children
(*innaaʔiika*) drinking? (*isko*)
b. I am reading _____. b. The children are drinking
_____.